

3.3.3 Digestion and absorption

Content	Opportunities for skills development
During digestion, large biological molecules are hydrolysed to smaller molecules that can be absorbed across cell membranes. Digestion in mammals of: • carbohydrates by amylases and membrane-bound disaccharidases • lipids by lipase, including the action of bile salts • proteins by endopeptidases, exopeptidases and membrane-bound dipeptidases. Mechanisms for the absorption of the products of digestion by cells lining the ileum of mammals, to include: • co-transport mechanisms for the absorption of amino acids and of monosaccharides • the role of micelles in the absorption of lipids.	PS 1.1 Students could: • design and carry out investigations into the effect of a pH or bile salts on the rate of reaction catalysed by a digestive enzyme • use Visking tubing models to investigate the absorption of the products of digestion.